Decisions about AI are reshaping our communities. We the people should have a say in how.

BLOOM PROJECT

CALL FOR FOUNDING CIVIC HOSTS

The Public Assembly on AI

Join local organizations across the country in founding a new civic institution, where communities work out what they want from AI and carry it from local decisions to the national stage.

Applications due November 20, 2026

THE MOMENT

AI is accelerating choices about our society's future.

How we live and work

How power and prosperity are shared

What our communities become

Enormous sums are being spent to build and deploy AI.

Almost nothing is being invested in our capacity to shape our future together as communities and publics in the AI era.

The invitation

Over the past year BLOOM and local partners have built and tested a community assembly model that gives people a real say in decisions about AI in their communities and our country — and we are now inviting partner organizations to join us in founding the Public Assembly on AI as a new, lasting civic institution



~1,000
people engaged across our 2026 pilots

6
counties, in Utah and Central Oregon

70+
delegates across civic assemblies in Utah and Oregon

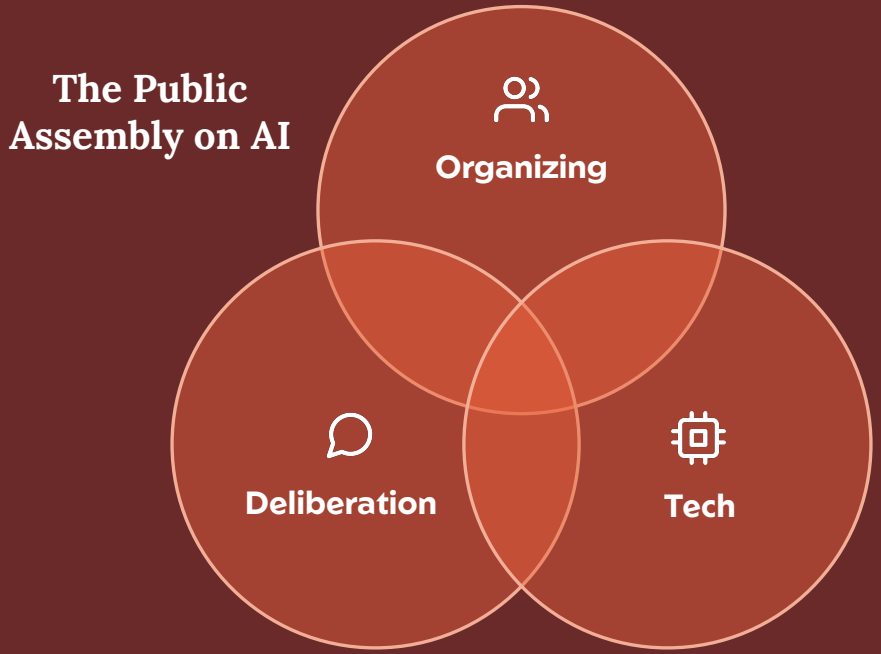
COMPLETED **Utah Solutions Forum · Draper, September 18–19, 2026**

38 delegates selected by civic lottery took up the public's role in AI decisions and produced 10 policy recommendations, each with at least 82% agreement.

THE PUBLIC ASSEMBLY MODEL

Three legs of a new civic institution

Public priorities from deliberation become civic power and action through broad-based organizing.



Organizing

Building relationships and coalitions for civic power

Deliberation

Good information, cross-difference dialogue, and supermajority priorities

Tech

Links public deliberations across places and creates scale

How the Public Assembly on AI works

Ordinary people work out what they want to happen on AI, starting in local communities and building up to the whole country.

1 **Locally**
A pressing local AI issue

› 2 **State**
Questions beyond one community

› 3 **National**
Questions no state can resolve alone

LOCAL

Community Assembly

Who takes part
Anyone in the community, recruited across differences

How long
10–12 weeks (core arc) to six months (co-design)

What it produces
Public judgment for local decision-makers, and state asks

STATE & NATIONAL

Civic Assembly

Who takes part
Delegates chosen by civic lottery, paid for their time

How long
Multi-day, around a specific charge

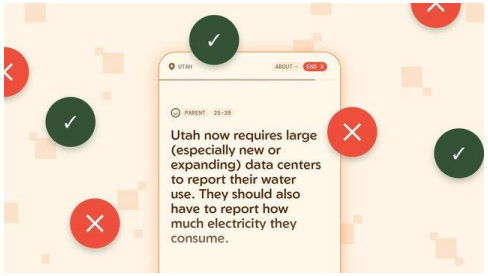
What it produces
Recommendations to legislatures and governors

HOW IT WORKS · TECH & PRODUCT

CivicOS makes deliberation accessible & scalable



Live Conversations



Digital Participation



Reports & Insights

Public deliberation should be easy to convene, magnetic, and impossible to ignore.

Impact

1

Institutional & policy

Every host identifies decision-makers and decisions on a timeline: a county commission vote, a district's classroom policy, an employer's deployment plan, a state bill. What the community concludes is delivered to that body publicly, carried by the organized constituency hosts build and by advocacy partners.

2

Citizen and civil society action

Much of what a community decides it wants needs no official's permission — a union bargaining over workplace monitoring, a parent council adopting school guidance, a library running AI literacy sessions. We help you track and report this on equal footing with the first category.

3

Self-efficacy and personal development

Participants leave with the experience of being heard, practice in deliberation and facilitation, and relationships with neighbors they would not otherwise have met. The bench of hosts and co-hosts you build tends to outlast the arc and becomes local civic capacity. Together with standing hubs and a network that keeps commissioning assemblies, that is what makes this a lasting civic institution.

What we provide to hosts

FUNDING

Civic host, core

$10,000–$30,000

Civic host, co-design

$50,000–$60,000

per site from the BLOOM Project

Amounts are set in co-design by the scale of your public, the number of co-hosts, and travel. Grants cover staff time, venue and food, translation and interpretation, and local outreach. BLOOM makes host grants directly, including in hub states.

- **Method** — A playbook built from our two pilots in Utah and Oregon, refined with and for this cohort.
- **Platform** — CivicOS, the open-source deliberation suite shown earlier, free to use. Your contact list stays yours.
- **Training** — Facilitation and organizing, plus coaching, through your hub or BLOOM.
- **Synthesis** — The ability to synthesize what people say across all levels of discussion, with tools for presenting it beautifully to the people you are trying to reach.
- **A peer cohort** — A national network of hosts on the same timeline, plus a state cluster where there is a hub.

BLOOM PROJECT

Which host scope fits you?

1 Civic host, core · $10–30k

You are rooted in a town, county, or constituency and can reach most of it. Over 10–12 weeks you bring your community's voice into the state process, surfacing common-ground solutions you can act on locally and priorities that need state or national action.

2 Civic host, co-design · $50–60k

You engage a larger-scale public with a live local decision and a named decision-maker. From February to July you run a full community assembly, through to a public ratification. We will select up to three.

Backed by civic hubs

State or Regional Civic hubs coach your team, set shared questions with hosts in their area, and support carrying what your community concludes to state decision-makers. Where a state or region has no hub yet, BLOOM plays this role.

Work in this manner and want to serve as a hub? Write to hello@bloom-project.org to start a conversation.

What a host does

Over 10–12 weeks, hosts bring their community's voice forward: finding common ground that's actionable locally, and naming what needs state or national action.

~120

hours led by one to two people

THE PLAYBOOK

One-to-ones

Conversations that bring local leaders into the inquiry on your chosen AI issue.

Community Forums

30–50 residents meet to sort out local priorities, name local actions, and flag what needs state action.

Open poll

Engage hundreds of residents to create a map of the opinion landscape on local questions, with beautiful reporting and analysis baked in.

Your hub and BLOOM support synthesis across hosts

You report what your community concluded and what needs state action. We synthesize across sites and bring it back to hosts to reveal shared challenges that could benefit from citizen deliberation at the state or national levels.

What a co-design host does

A deeper six-month process on a live local decision: from agenda setting to recommendations your community ratifies, with support to put them in front of decision-makers.

$50–60k
per co-design site

THE PHASES

Agenda setting

The core arc: one-to-ones, cafe, house meetings, open poll, and sense-making.

Goals and ideas

Cafe and poll rounds on values and goals; working groups draft options from research.

Tradeoffs and decisions

3–5 hour sessions and polls seeking broad agreement across viewpoints, then a public ratification vote.

Guided by a local steering committee

Local leaders from across your community choose the issues and vouch for the process. Topic working groups are tested alongside it, and checkpoints between phases sort local actions from what needs state action

How civic hubs & BLOOM support hosts

A HUB PROVIDES

Coaching

Help shaping your arc in co-design, then coaching that tapers as you take the lead.

A shared question

Set with you and the other hosts in your state, so your community's voice connects to theirs.

State synthesis

Your findings combined with other hosts' to show where people agree and what needs state action.

Steering committee

Cross-partisan state leaders who set the assembly's charge, with seats for hosts.

Impact table

Advocacy partners who carry what your community ratifies to state leaders, engaging only after ratification.

Ecosystem table

Practitioners, media, and allied networks that extend your reach and backfill facilitation.

What we're looking for

Where hosts work

A civic host is a local organization with the relationships to convene across divides in its community. Hosts have deep roots in a place and a community of people: a county, a town, or a constituency. We consider each of these communities a public.

Ideal partners are rooted in publics where something clear is at stake: ideally a decision about AI that a nameable body will make on a nameable timeline.

Central Oregon is a public. Southwestern Pennsylvania is a public. So is the Denver metropolitan area, or a coalition of faith communities spread across Utah. Statewide organizations can propose a single region as a host site.

Potential topics

Hosts choose the issues most relevant to their community, set with their hub where there is one.

- **Data centers & AI infrastructure**
- **Jobs and workforce**
- **AI in K–12 and higher education**
- **Surveillance and privacy**

Who this will influence

We help you identify which decision-makers and which decisions your assembly can influence. Depending on location and issue, that could be a county commission or city council, a school board, a state legislature, a mayor or governor, or a major employer.

How we will assess potential hosts

We are looking for hosts with four key attributes, and relationships across difference matter most. Organizations and coalitions of any size are welcome, as are fiscally sponsored organizations.

1 Existing relationships and convening capacity

Enough standing with enough different people to convene partners — faith, labor, youth and education, small business, neighborhood and civic, or whoever the real constituencies are where you are.

2 A commitment to build collaborative politics

Drawn to finding out what people think through deliberation, rather than confirming what you already believe.

3 Organizing or policy capacity

We bring what we can on synthesis and reporting, and help identify pathways to political impact. Hosts who know local decision-makers and can turn people out through their networks will likely be more successful.

4 Willingness to share feedback openly

We need both excitement about the possibilities and a willingness to point out what isn't working.

Timeline

Oct 15, 2026
Applications open

Nov 20, 2026
Applications close

Dec 2026
Interviews

Jan 15, 2027
Hosts notified

Feb–Jul 2027
Community assembly arc

First half 2028
National assembly on AI

Selection Process

The application takes about an hour. Shortlisted finalists are invited to an interview phase in December. Being invited is not a guarantee of selection.

The arc

Hosts are notified by January 15. Core hosts run 10–12 week arcs between February and July 2027, with staggered starts; co-design hosts run across the full window. Together, this network will have the opportunity to commission state or national assemblies on AI in 2028.

About BLOOM

We help people go beyond divisions to breakthrough common ground solutions where the sum is greater than the parts.

THE TEAM



Rahmin Sarabi

Co-Founder and Co-ED. Leads programs and CivicOS.



Clara Long

Co-Founder and Co-ED Leads fundraising, communications, partnerships, and policy.



Zabrae Valentine

Deliberation design & capacity building; co-author of a practical guide to forum assemblies.



Humphrey Obuobi

Design lead from host recruitment to community cafe methods and products to support it all.



Mike Grafton

Engineering lead for CivicOS, with our engineering partner Crown Shy.



Audrey Tang

Founding Senior Advisor. Taiwan's former Minister of Digital Affairs.

BLOOM PROJECT

APPLICATIONS OPEN OCTOBER 15, 2026

Build your community's civic power and agency over the AI decisions ahead.

Apply by November 20, 2026

Questions, or interested in serving as a state or regional civic hub?
hello@bloom-project.org